



DATA STORYTELLING & BRAND INSIGHTS

Back at the Desk

The process behind the business case

Gabriel Croquer · July 2026

Initial challenges: scope and creativity

Narrow the scope

The report can't be too broad. With a base as rich as Clara's, too many strong themes compete for a single study.

Avoid repeating past reports

To show creativity, the study had to open a new subject, not re-run a theme Clara already published.

Clara's published reports

AI theme **already done four times**

Clara AI Report · Quando a IA entra no Caixa · AI Monitor

Strong themes still open

- O Custo Invisível do Pré-pago
- El tanque que se vacía dos veces (fleet fuel, MX)
- El punto ciego de los viajes corporativos (travel, MX)
- Clara Radar de marcas (2023, 1.6M transactions)

Great themes that deserve a rebranded re-edition: more proprietary data, launched in Brazil.

On-site vs remote work: the ongoing debate

Chosen over spend policy, which folds into the study as H5 (Ramp already owns the generic policy angle).

Criteria

- ✓ Generates press coverage
- ✓ Sparks conversations on social media
- ✓ Positions Clara as the leading authority on corporate spending in Latin America

What perspective?



First angle. Use Clara's data to measure on-site work activity and attendance.

Flawed, risky, complicated: Clara has no headcount, and the VR blind spot breaks the presence proxy.

DISCARDED



Pivoted back to basics. Use Clara's data to measure how much companies spend on on-site work.

Clara Workplace Index

Recurring Recurrence builds authority

The AI workflow

AI agent teams swarmed to deep research.

10+

agents in parallel

250+

searches & page reads

2,849

URLs mapped from Clara's sitemap

- ✓ Locate old reports among archived pages (many were taken down; the sitemap revealed what was still live).
- ✓ Benchmark reports on on-site vs remote work.

Although AI can do it faster, it can't do it smarter. It reads snippets of archived pages and reports them as if seen. Rule adopted: a number counts only when opened at its primary source. A snippet is a lead, not a source.

Defining and sharpening the hypotheses

Conservative by instinct: 4 of 5 provable on Clara's data alone. External sources reinforce, they don't prove.

H1

The office is going on-demand

PROVABLE ON INTERNAL DATA

H2

What it costs to run an office now

PROVABLE ON INTERNAL DATA

H3

The office runs three days

PROVABLE ON INTERNAL DATA

H4

Companies pay for more office than they use

NEEDS EXTERNAL SUPPORT

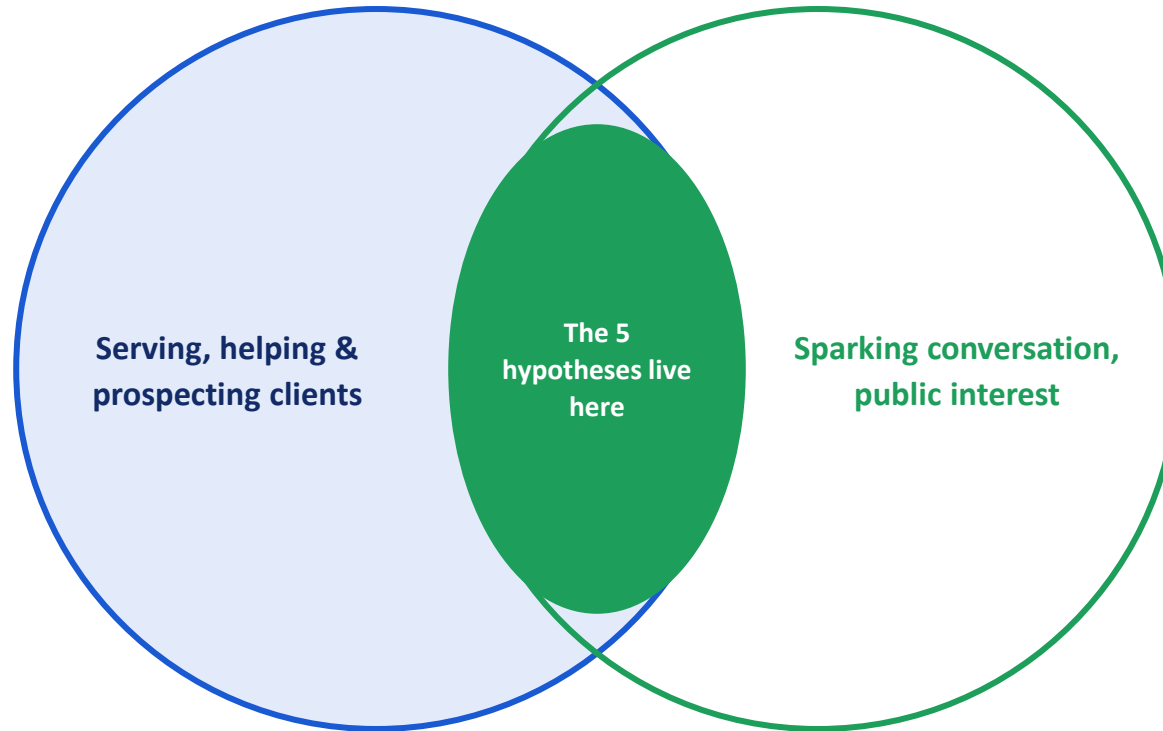
H5

A spend policy is the lever that works on office cost

PROVABLE ON INTERNAL DATA

Defining and sharpening the hypotheses

Journalist's instinct: chase the controversy, but never expose a client, and hand CFOs something usable.



Chosen headline

“The five-day office is losing its lease: X% of LatAm companies' workplace spend is now flexible”

Why this headline

- ✓ Provable on internal data
- ✓ Sparks conversation
- ✓ Positions Clara as an authority
- ✓ Converges with H4 (companies pay for more office than they use)

Adapting to each channel

Tier-1 media story. Reporters' WhatsApp is flooded with pitches; lead with a short lede and research what they actually cover.

LinkedIn. The visualization does the communicating.

Clara's owned channels. Readers want detail and numbers; fewer limits, they arrive with time to read.

Methods and limits

Proxy, not attendance. Spending is a trace of office activity, not a count of people.

Fixed cohort. Every time series runs on a fixed cohort of companies.

External data labeled. Vacancy, rent and utilization are always labeled by source.

Privacy. Minimum cell size, no cut below 30 companies. We never expose a client.